



INDIA IN YEAR 2008, FUTURE AHEAD!

The year 2008 had been a mixed bag for the Indian electronics industry. Especially, the economic slowdown raised clouds of confusion and fear. But the companies continued to thrive despite all odds. Tomorrow is uncertain, but the companies seem prepared and upbeat about the Indian electronics industry.

Celebrating the anniversary issue of the magazine we caught up with some of the leaders in the electronics space and asked about their vision for the industry. We tried to cover as many sub-sets as possible within the electronics industry. One thing that we found common amongst most of the responses was that everyone is quite confident about

the potential India holds. While many choose to stay away from the most hard-hitting question "how to survive the economic slowdown," some did touch upon the topic. Here are the versions from some of the leading companies of India.

■ EFY BUREAU

LG Electronics India

The economy will boom soon

The Indian market looks very promising with the new-age consumers not only looking at mobility and basic computing features but yearning for more technologically advanced features. To be able to pre-empt their needs and match up to their expectations is a challenge that companies need to live up to.

The market is fast moving towards high-end customised products which are both technologically advanced and aesthetically designed to complement the modern households. The need right now is to continuously innovate and come out with product variations across categories to meet the expectations of a varied class of customers.

Consumers are now looking at products which are not only functional but have futuristic design and sleek looks to match their home interiors also. In such a scenario, it has become imperative for companies to take product design seriously and since refrigerators are an integral part of home appliances, their designing is crucial. Also, when consumers step out to buy

any consumer durable product, their biggest needs are for product quality, performance and service.

To conclude, our top priority in coming years will be to maximise customer satisfaction and heighten the competitive edge of our flagship products. Though the recent global recession has had its effect across sectors, we at LG believe that ups and downs in the economy are a usual feature and follow each other. That's how the economic cycle works. After this entire US sub-prime crisis, which has also affected the Indian businesses to a great extent, there has been a considerable slowdown in the industrial growth. But we acknowledge that this is a temporary phase. The economy will boom soon.



V. Ramachandran,
director-marketing, LG EIL

As told to MONIKA BHATI